

Now let's look at a tougher case.

My Division. My body is fatally injured, as are the brains of my two brothers. My brain is divided, and each half is successfully transplanted into the body of one of my brothers. Each of the resulting people believes that he is me, seems to remember living my life, has my character, and is in every other way psychologically continuous with me. And he has a body that is very like mine.

Let's call the resulting people *Lefty* and *Righty*. Then we seem to have four options:

- (1) You survive as A.
- (2) You survive as B.
- (3) You survive as both A and B.
- (4) You do not survive.

Parfit argues that none of (1)–(3) can be true. So, he thinks, we are stuck with
option (4): you do not survive.

But this looks bad for the psychological theory; after all, you seem to have the right kinds of connections to both A and B.

That is why, he thinks, you can survive Hemisphere Transplant but not My
Division.

Notice that a materialist could say much the same thing. They could say that what is required for your survival is a non-branching material relation to some future thing.

But here is an odd consequence of this view. Suppose that you wake up, and are told that you are the result of a hemisphere transplant operation. Next to you on another hospital bed is a body into whom the other hemisphere was transplanted.

You do not yet know whether that body will awake.

You think that you know that you are the person you remember being. But, if that other body survives to become a living person, you will not be the person you remember being.



Here's a quite different way of responding to My Division. Recall this option:

This also gives the psychological theorist the resources to resist the Teletransportation Argument. On this kind of view, premises (1) and (2) are false, because the psychological connections to Marsy and Venusy are branching connections.

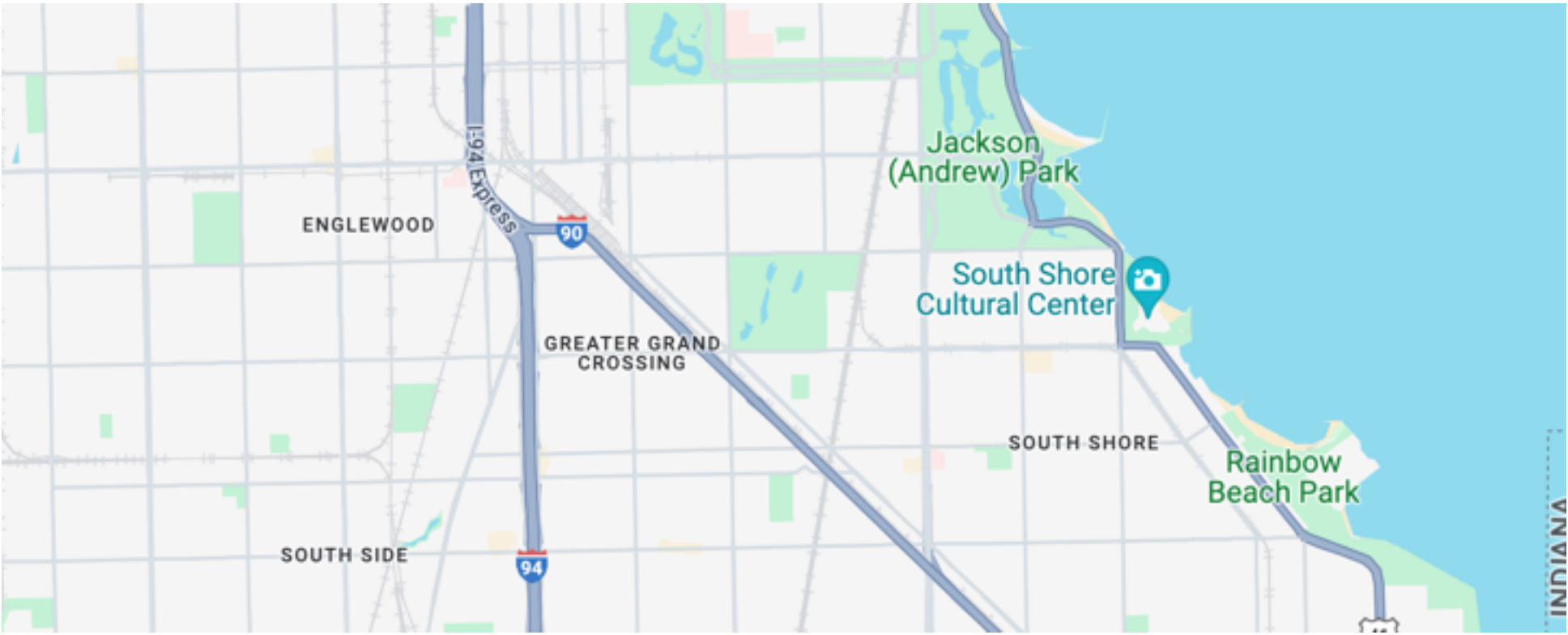
You survive as
Lefty and Righty.

We rejected this on the grounds that Lefty is not identical to Righty, so that you cannot be identical to both. But this neglects a possibility: maybe you were already

Lefty and Righty. You thought that you were one person; but in fact you were already two.

This is a strange and surprising view. Here is one way to get your mind around it.

Consider a case in which two roads 'overlap' in space.



ENGLEWOOD

Jackson
(Andrew) Park

South Shore
Cultural Center

GREATER GRAND
CROSSING

SOUTH SHORE

Rainbow
Beach Park

SOUTH SIDE

INDIANA

One can describe this situation in a way which makes it seem mysterious. I-90 and I-94 are separate highways; the stretch of highway north of 65th street is one highway; and yet it is identical to both I-90 and I-94. How can this be???

The puzzle here is only superficial. Roads are things which have different spatial parts located in different places. Two roads can occupy the same space just by sharing some of the same parts. No big deal.

options:

Let's call the resulting people Lefty and Righty. Then we see to have four

(2) You survive as B.

(1) You survive as A.

(3) You survive as both A and B.

(4) You do not survive.

Parfit argues that none of (1)-(3) can be true. So, he thinks, we are stuck with

option(4): you do not survive.

right kinds of connections to both A and B.

But this book bad for the psychological theory; after all, you seem to have the

That is why, he thinks, you can survive Hemispher Transplant but not My

Diviſion.

required for you survival is a non-branching material relation to some future thing.

Notice that a materialist could say much the same thing. They could say that what is

You do not yet know whether that body will awake.

But here is another sequence of this view. Suppose that you wake up, and are



another hospital bed is already in the vault where this one was transplanted.

told that you are the result of a hemisphere transplant. Next to you on

You think that you know what you are thinking. But, if that

remember being.

other body survives to become a living person, you will not be the person you

Teletransportation Argument. On this kind of view, premises (1) and (2) are false,

connections.

This also gives the psychological theorist the resources to resist the

because the psychological connections to Mars and Venus are branching

You survive as
Lefty and Righty.

Rejected this on the grounds that Lefty is not identical to Righty, so that you

cannot be identical to both. But this neglects a possibility: maybe you're already

all ready two.

Lefty and Righty. Youth that you were on; but in fact you were



This is a strange and surprising view. Here is one way to get your mind around it.

Consider a case in which two roads 'overlap' in space.

One can describe this situation in a way which makes it seem mysterious. 1-90 and

94 are separate highways; the stretch of highway north of 65th street is one

highway; and yet it is identical to both I-90 and I-94. How can this be???

parts located in different places. Two roads can occupy the same space just by

The puzzle here is only superficial. Roads are things which have different spatial

sharing some of the same parts. No big deal.